confirmed this to *Tehelka*). He said the STF extorted large sums of money from him for not arresting him. But he was detained as late as 2000 and was offered the job of a special police officer. He met Tariq (a co-accused, who is absconding) in the STF camp, where the latter was working. It was Tariq who introduced Mohammad to him in the STF camp. The alleged role of the STF in the Parliament attack, as per the court record, has not been investigated at all. Davinder Singh confirmed that no investigator ever got back to him and sought clarification on his alleged role in sending Mohammad to Delhi with Afzal's help. 'Why will they ask me this? He [Afzal] is saying this to save his own skin,' said Singh.

Denying the allegations, Singh asked, 'Do you want to say that we are behind the Parliament attack?' He also acknowledged that he had once detained Afzal for interrogation. 'We had reliable information that he knew the whereabouts of Ghazi Baba, one of the most dreaded terrorists in Kashmir [and an accused in the case]. But we couldn't get anything out of him and let him go.'

Later, the Delhi Police Special Cell had only Afzal to identify the bodies of the five assassins gunned down in Parliament. There is no other corroborative evidence that sheds light on the identities of these five terrorists. However, in court, Afzal denied identifying them. 'I had not identified any terrorists. Police told me the names of the terrorists and forced me to identify them,' Afzal told the court in his statement made under Section 313 of the Criminal Procedure Code.[5]

In the absence of any direct evidence against Afzal, the Supreme Court said in its judgement: 'The incident, which resulted in heavy casualty, has shaken the entire nation and the collective conscience of the society will only be satisfied if capital punishment will be awarded to the offender.'[6] Haksar does not agree with the court's view. 'The Supreme Court,' she says, 'has not passed any strictures against the corrupt officers for their shoddy and illegal investigations and has held that there is no direct evidence against Afzal. However they have confirmed the death sentence because they believe that this death is necessary to assuage Indian citizens.'

Another controversy that was brushed aside in the investigations was one that again pointed to a possible Jammu and Kashmir police connection with the Parliament attack. The Thane Police swung into action after the identity of the five terrorists killed in the Parliament attack was made public. S.M. Shangari,